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Daily Current Affairs · 5 November 2026

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DAILY UPDATE · 05 NOVEMBER 2026

5 November 2026 — Daily Current Affairs

This selection is based on official government releases published on 4 November 2026. The announcement date and event date may differ; both are stated where relevant.

Uttar Pradesh · Education & Culture

Preparations reviewed for Kashi Tamil Sangamam 5.0 in Varanasi

A high-level meeting was held at Banaras Hindu University (BHU), Varanasi, on 3 November to review preparations for the fifth Kashi Tamil Sangamam. The programme is proposed from **28 November to 12 December 2026**. Its theme is “Thirukkural Payilvom – Let us learn the Thirukkural”. Varanasi, Prayagraj and Ayodhya are included in the programme. The initiative aims to strengthen educational, cultural and linguistic exchanges between Tamil Nadu and Kashi/Uttar Pradesh.

Exam relevance: Uttar Pradesh, culture, education and national integration.

Official source: PIB — Ministry of Education, 4 Nov 2026.

Environment · Biodiversity

2026 guidelines issued for India’s I-OECMs

India’s Environment Ministry issued national guidelines during CBD COP-17 to identify and report Other Effective Area-Based Conservation Measures (OECMs). These may be areas that are not legally notified protected areas but make an effective contribution to long-term biodiversity conservation. Examples include community-managed water bodies, sacred groves, biodiversity parks and some coastal or marine areas. I-OECM recognition does not automatically turn an area into a legally protected area or change its ownership.

Exam relevance: Biodiversity, in-situ conservation, the Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework and the 30x30 target.

Official source: PIB — MoEFCC, 4 Nov 2026.

International Relations · Defence

First India–Canada Defence Dialogue held

The first defence dialogue between India and Canada was held virtually on 3 November 2026. Discussions covered defence policy, strategic perspectives, defence industry, military-technical cooperation and defence research and development. The PIB release describes a dialogue on potential areas of cooperation; it should not be reported as a signed defence agreement or a joint military exercise.

Exam relevance: India’s bilateral relations, defence diplomacy and the Indo-Pacific context.

Official source: PIB — Ministry of Defence, 4 Nov 2026.

Economy · Critical Minerals

₹2,814 crore approved for lithium and nickel processing

The Union Cabinet approved a Capex Support Scheme with an outlay of **₹2,814 crore** to promote processing of critical minerals, including lithium and nickel. Critical minerals are important to the supply chains for the energy transition, batteries, electronics and advanced manufacturing.

Exam relevance: Mineral resources, energy security, battery value chains and import dependence. Consult the original Cabinet release for eligibility and benefit conditions.

Official source: PIB — Cabinet releases, 4 Nov 2026.

Parliamentary System · Accountability

Digital audit monitoring platform discussed for Public Accounts Committees

Releases from the Lok Sabha Secretariat on 4 November highlighted the need for a shared Digital Audit Monitoring Platform for State Legislatures, modelled on parliamentary systems. The Public Accounts Committee (PAC) plays an important role in legislative scrutiny of government expenditure and appropriation accounts.

Exam relevance: Parliamentary committees, financial accountability, CAG reports and legislative oversight.

Official source: PIB — Lok Sabha Secretariat releases, 4 Nov 2026.

Quick revision: Kashi Tamil Sangamam 5.0 — 28 November to 12 December 2026; I-OECMs — effective conservation outside formally protected areas; India–Canada — first defence dialogue; Critical Minerals — lithium and nickel processing.

Daily Practice Questions — 5 November 2026

1. When is Kashi Tamil Sangamam 5.0 proposed? **28 November–12 December 2026.**
2. What does I-OECM recognition automatically do to land ownership or legal protected-area status? **Neither: it does not automatically change ownership or confer legal protected-area status.**
3. When was the first India–Canada Defence Dialogue held? **Virtually on 3 November 2026.**
4. What is the approved outlay for the critical-mineral processing Capex Support Scheme? **₹2,814 crore.**
5. What does the Public Accounts Committee scrutinise? **Government expenditure and appropriation accounts.**